

Reversal of mates

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Reciprocal change of mates is a basic but ever appealing pattern theme which shows reversal of mates after two black defences from set or try play to post key. Hundreds of highly original two-movers featuring this theme have been composed over the past six decades but yet innovative composers use complex matrices to ring original changes. It is amazing that many of the problems on this theme still find their way into FIDE Albums, which is an authentic compilation of world's best chess compositions. In this article I present three Reciprocal changes from the latest FIDE Album. The first one by the World's best two-move composer at present, is a rare example featuring castling key.

Marjan Kovacevic
First prize, Igalo 2013



Mate in two

In the diagram position mates are set as 1...Qxa6 2.Qd4 **A**; 1...Qxf4 2.Qe5 **B**. The key **1.0-0-0!** with threat 2.Re1 forces the black defences 1...Qxa6 2.Qe5; **B** 1...Qxf4 2.Qd4 **A**. The castling key loses control of e2,f2 but gains guard of d3,d4 to effect the mate reversal.

Evgeni Bourd
2nd Prize, 106 TT SuperProblem 2014



Mate in two

After try 1.Bd5? the threat is 2.Qc6 1...Nxd7 2.Rxe6 **A**; 1...Nxd5 2.Nf5 **B**. **Key 1.Ne5!**(2.Qb8) 1...Nd7 2.Nf5 **B** 1...Nd5 2.Rxe6 **A**. This talented Israeli composer adds a nice touch by bringing back the threats as mates apart from the reversal of mates. After key 1...Bxc6 2.Qxc6 and after try 1.Bd5? 1...Bxd7 2.Qb8.

Finally one more Marjan's marvel, this time in Meredith, for solving.

Marjan Kovacevic
I prize, Uralski Problemist AT 20, 2013



Mate in two

Solution to problem for solving in the article' on problem economy'
Key 1.Bxf7! zugzwang 1...c6 2.Bxd6; 1...Rc6 2.Nb6; 1...Bc6 2.Qa7; 1...Be6 2.h8Q; 1...Re6 2.Nxf5.

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